

TOPIC 6: BASIC SOFTWARE CONCEPTS

1. Meaning of Software

Software is the set of instructions (programs) that tell the computer hardware what to do. Unlike hardware, software cannot be touched; it is intangible.

2. System Software

Software that manages the computer itself and provides a platform for application software.

- **Operating System (OS)** – e.g. Windows, macOS, Linux, Android, iOS. Controls hardware, files, memory and user interface.
- Utility programs – antivirus, disk cleaners, backup tools.

3. Application Software

Software designed for specific user tasks.

- Word processors (Microsoft Word, Google Docs)
- Spreadsheets (Excel, Google Sheets)
- Web browsers (Chrome, Firefox, Edge)
- Presentation software (PowerPoint)
- Graphics and media software, games, educational apps

4. Functions of an Operating System

- Manages hardware resources (CPU, memory, storage)
- Provides user interface (desktop, icons, menus)
- Runs and manages application programs
- Handles files and folders
- Controls security and user access
- Manages input and output devices

5. Summary

Software is the set of programs that run on hardware. System software (especially the OS) manages the computer; application software helps users perform specific tasks such as writing, calculating or browsing.

End of Topic 6